



Growing Your Business

For your business to grow, you will need to sell more of what you are currently offering. There are many ways of doing this, from finding new customers to coaxing existing customers to spend more.

Developing a growth strategy

To give your business the best chance to grow, you need to decide on a strategy for retaining buyers, winning repeat sales, and expanding your customer base. This may include offering enhanced customer care, better delivery options, improving existing products or services, and offering new ones—all of

which should fuel growth and keep you ahead of your competitors. While lack of growth or slow growth is clearly undesirable, it is important to manage the growth process. Growing too fast can knock your business plan off course. Think ahead and ensure that you can increase financing, staffing, production capacity, and your supply of materials when needed.

Cultivating success

Increasing sales is challenging, but by applying simple strategies to your business, and developing your employees' capabilities, you can achieve growth.

PROMOTING GROWTH

Nurture existing customers and improve service to encourage loyalty. Reach out to new customers through social media and email, local networking, advertising, and marketing (see pp.198–199).

MANAGING GROWTH

Pay attention to talented personnel who have the potential to grow your business. Maximize cash availability and borrowing power so you can fund growth strategies (see pp.196–197), and invest in systems and tools to help you.